INB INDIA NETWORK BULLETIN · EDITION 009 THURSDAY 15 OCTOBER 2026 · 08:30 IST

NH-48 reopens, and Punjab shuts for the day

● NETWORK: AMBER

Belagavi's cane farmers lifted their NH-48 blockades on Wednesday evening[1] and turned on the sugar mills instead, so the trucks are moving and the cane tractors aren't. Punjab is shut today for a bandh, with a highway block near Jalandhar from 10 to 2. And two more ships sank at Hormuz[2], while wholesale prices hit a record 11.39% in September, with fuel and power up about a quarter[3].

HOW'S EACH REGION HOLDING UP?



DATES TO WATCH

● Thu 15 Oct	Punjab bandh and Jalandhar highway block[4]
● 15–24 Oct	Kolkata Puja curbs and immersions[5]
● 15–17 Oct	Riyadh airport shut
● 17–24 Oct	Petrapole–Benapole shut to cargo[6]
● 26–27 Oct	Kolkata Puja curbs and immersions[5], again
● 26 Oct–5 Nov	NH-10 night closures[7]
● Sat 31 Oct	Delhi's BS-IV entry window ends[8]
● Sun 1 Nov	CMA CGM's new North Europe–India rates[9]

● GREEN — the sale season as usual, which can still be busy

● AMBER — something beyond the season is slowing freight

● RED — something is stopping freight across a state or a route

North ● AMBER

Punjab is shut today for a bandh over the killing of anti-drug activist Parminder Singh Jhota in Mansa; farm unions and traders back it, and toll workers say plazas will be free[10]. Police have barricaded the roads into Mansa, and buses on the Barnala road didn't turn up yesterday[11]. So loads into south Punjab wait a day, and shops that shut won't take deliveries.

West ● AMBER

The cane farmers have moved from the highway to the sugar mills: from today they march on mills in Satara and Sangli, to stop sugar leaving the warehouses and cane reaching the mills[12]. Tuesday's three-hour block on the Pune–Solapur highway at Bhimanagar left queues of 2 to 2.5 km[13]. So sugar from western Maharashtra can be held mill by mill, and a highway can stop for hours without notice.

South ● AMBER

Karnataka's farmers cleared their blockades at Bankapur and Yarikoppa late on Wednesday and are walking to Dharwad and Hubballi instead[1]. The trucks that queued there since Tuesday are moving, slowly, so I'd expect Pune–Bengaluru loads to run a day or two behind while the queue clears.

East ● AMBER

Kalinga ghat is still shut, so Berhampur–Phulbani trucks go the long way round. Paradip, meanwhile, loaded a record 140,022 tonnes of coal in a day on 10th October[14], so the coal berths, at least, are keeping up. Kolkata's Puja curbs are the usual strain[5]: deliveries into the city run in set hours, no slower than the season. And from Saturday Petrapole stops taking cargo for Bangladesh.

Northeast ● AMBER

The coke trucks held at the Bengal border are the Northeast's one disruption, and the latest report is from Tuesday. So I'm rating it as if they're still stuck: Assam coke for plants outside the state stays held.

Central ● GREEN

No delay beyond the season.

NETWORK INSIGHTS

1 Two more ships sink at Hormuz

Sea freight from India to the Gulf ports

AMBER · HIGH COST OF DELAY · HIGH CONFIDENCE

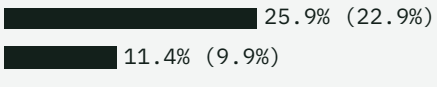
GFS Pride, a Singapore-flagged container ship of 2,824 TEU, sank near the Strait of Hormuz after being hit by a projectile[2]. A day later GFS Giselle, a second container ship from the same company, was hit and damaged[15]. Cape Dao, a bulk carrier hit on 23rd September, went down too[16]. Attacks have surged over the past 10 days, mostly on tankers, but container ships have been hit, stopped or sunk as well[16].

> **Exporters shipping to Jebel Ali, Dammam, Kuwait and Qatar, the ports inside the strait, are the ones at risk. A box that still goes the short way is now a war risk, and the detours round it are slower and dearer.**

2 Wholesale prices hit a record

HIGH CONFIDENCE

Wholesale prices, September, % above a year ago (August in brackets)[3]



Wholesale prices are at a series high, with fuel and power leading, and ICRA expects 12% in October and double digits through December[3]. Does diesel get cheaper soon? The IEA actually thinks not: world diesel supply falls short of demand this quarter, and the stocks lost in the war won't be rebuilt before the second half of 2027[17].

> **Shippers with a fuel clause in their freight contracts carry this: each reset is dearer than the last, well into next year.**

3 Saudi cargo goes by road

Air exports from India to Saudi Arabia

AMBER · HIGH COST OF DELAY · MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

Riyadh's main airport has been shut since a Houthi attack on 10th October, and Logistics Insider reports freighters going to Jeddah or Dammam, with the cargo finishing the trip by road[18]. Is that the end of it? Well, no: a notice now keeps Riyadh closed until the evening of 17th October, and Air France-KLM has cancelled Riyadh to the end of the month, so belly space stays short after the runway opens[18].

> **Indian perishables and urgent parts bound for Riyadh are the ones at risk: the road leg from Jeddah or Dammam adds time and another handling, and fruit doesn't wait.**

THE LANES I'M WATCHING

NH-48 Pune–Bengaluru — AMBER

KOGNOLI, HATTARGI, BANKAPUR, YARIKOPPA

The blockade ended on Wednesday evening after 31 hours, with about 150 heavy vehicles stuck on the Maharashtra side alone[12]. At Hattargi one side opened first, with the other expected by midnight[19]. Amber for a few days, while the queue works through.

NH-44 Jalandhar–Phagwara — AMBER

PUNJAB BANDH

BKU Doaba says it will block the Jalandhar–Phagwara stretch from 10 am to 2 pm today[4]. Trucks on the Delhi–Amritsar road wait out four hours near Jalandhar, or don't set out till the afternoon.

NH-27 at Srirampur — AMBER

THE NORTHEAST'S ROAD OUT

As of Tuesday, more than 300 trucks of Assam coke were held at the border, waiting since 17th September with their GST papers complete, and paying ₹4 lakh to ₹5 lakh a day in detention[20].

NH-157 Kalinga ghat — AMBER

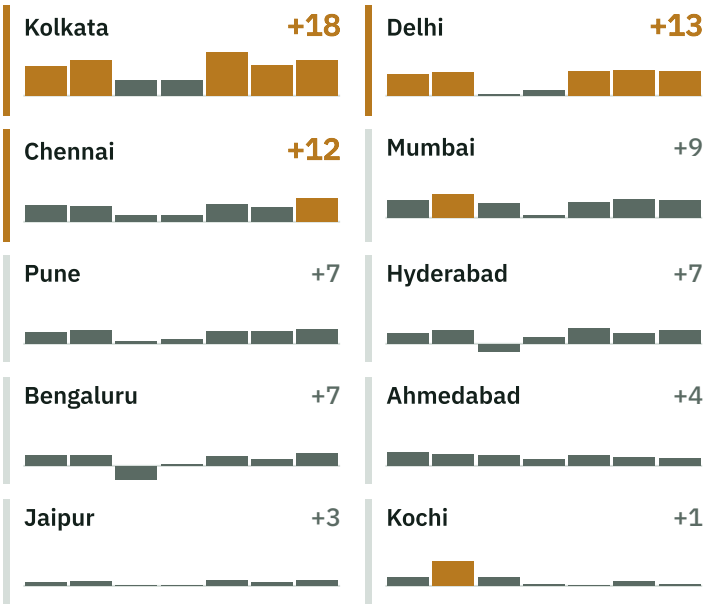
GANJAM TO KANDHAMAL, ODISHA

Shut for 20 days as of Tuesday, with light vehicles allowed through only 10–15 days after repairs finish[21]. Berhampur–Phulbani trucks take the long way round, adding hours each way.

MEASURED THIS MORNING

City roads against usual, daily, 8–14 Oct[22] amber = 10+ over

Kolkata, Delhi and Chennai stand out: 10+ points over usual on 14 Oct, Kolkata on 5 of the last 7 days, Delhi on 5 and Chennai on 1.



SOURCES

Built from public sources only. The ratings are my judgement on the likelihood of on-time delivery or cost-impact, not measured service levels or actual cost estimates. Confidence is High when the facts are dated and primary or measured, Medium when they rest on a proxy or a forecast. If I am wrong, we'll find out in the subsequent weeks. Map boundaries: DataMeet, CC BY 4.0.

1. The Hindu: Haveri and Dharwad blockades withdrawn, 14 Oct
2. Deccan Herald (Reuters): container ship sinks near Hormuz, 14 Oct
3. Rediff (PTI): wholesale inflation at 11.39% in September, 14 Oct
4. The Tribune: Jalandhar–Phagwara highway block planned, 15 Oct
5. Millennium Post: Kolkata Puja traffic plan, 5 Oct
6. Maritime Gateway: Petrapole–Benapole cargo halt, 13 Oct
7. ThePrint (PTI): NH-10 night curbs, 5 Oct
8. The Tribune: Delhi's BS-IV entry window to 31 Oct 2026
9. Maritime Gateway: CMA CGM North Europe–India rates, 13 Oct
10. Times of India: unions and traders back the Punjab bandh, tolls free, 15 Oct
11. Times of India: barricades on the roads to Mansa, 15 Oct
12. Times of India: farmers call off the NH-48 blockade after 31 hours, 15 Oct
13. ChiniMandi: cane blockades across western Maharashtra, 14 Oct
14. Maritime Gateway: Paradip's coal loading record, 14 Oct
15. Economic Times: two Singapore-registered ships hit, one sinks, 14 Oct
16. Baird Maritime (Reuters): two ships sink near Hormuz, 14 Oct
17. ThePrint: IEA on the diesel shortfall, 14 Oct
18. Logistics Insider: Riyadh airport closure hits air cargo, 14 Oct
19. All About Belgaum: traffic partly resumes on NH-48, 14 Oct
20. The Lallantop: 300 trucks at the Bengal border, 13 Oct
21. OdishaBytes: Kalinga ghat shut 20 days, 13 Oct
22. TomTom Traffic Index, ten cities